DAILY

Daily World Events Intelligence Summary — 2026-10-29

DTG 290730 CDT OCT 26

PERIOD 2026-10-28 ~0730 CT to 2026-10-29 ~0730 CT

daily · intel · world-events · US-impact · economy · Minnesota-costs · Iran · Hormuz · mines · tankers · UKMTO · Khasab · IRGC · MQM-170 · drone · Vance · Rezaei · Qatar · seven-day-plan · Araghchi · AP · Axios · post-midterm-strikes · Theodore-Roosevelt · Hegseth · Brett-Sylvia · J5 · leaks · Israel-election · Netanyahu · Eisenkot · Kuwait · Houthis · Saudi-Arabia · Eastern-Province · Aden · FOMC · Warsh · Cook · Hammack · Bank-of-Canada · Microsoft · Alphabet · Oracle · oil · Brent · WTI · Treasury-yields · PCE · GDP · gas-prices · gold · national-debt · Russia · Ukraine · Oleshky · Melania-Trump · Dnipro · Chernihiv · Kremenchuk · California-ballots · Judge-Carter · TRO-denied · Alaska · Dan-Sullivan · Peltola · Comey · Minnesota · James-OKeefe · Cam-Higby · Moriarty · vouching · Ilhan-Omar · Boasberg · midterms

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DAILY WORLD EVENTS INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY
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PREPARED FOR: Kyle Sibley
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

No US strike on Iran was reported this period. UKMTO reported a vessel on fire 9 NM north of Khasab, Oman, inside the Strait of Hormuz early on 29 OCT; the IRGC Navy then said three oil tankers struck mines and caught fire over the past 24 hours while using the “unauthorized southern route” the US has encouraged ships to use. The IRGC also says it electronically captured a US MQM-170 drone west of the strait. Neither Iranian claim is independently confirmed. The WSJ and NYT report Vice President Vance sent a letter, at Trump’s direction and via Qatar, to SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei proposing early US–Iran talks with Vance leading; Trump says the outreach is only about getting medical supplies into Iran. AP and Axios now report US allies were told to prepare for renewed strikes after 03 NOV, with Axios describing a possible seven-day US–Israeli operation; Trump has not decided. Hegseth fired the Joint Staff’s top planner, Lt. Gen. Brett Sylvia, over alleged leaks about the Iran and Ukraine wars. The Fed held at 3.75–4.00% in a 10–2 vote, with Governor Cook and Cleveland’s Hammack dissenting for a hike, and Warsh announced fewer rate-setting meetings from 2027. Stocks rose for a third day; Brent settled at $115.32 and was near $114 this morning. Q3 GDP and September PCE are due at 0730 CT, right at this report’s close. The Oleshky truce has held 54 hours, with aid due 30 OCT, while a Russian drone hit a train at Dnipro station today, killing at least 13. Judge Carter denied DOJ’s bid to set aside 20,000 California ballots. In Minnesota, Hennepin County charged James O’Keefe and Cam Higby with felony unlawful voting and identity theft. MN regular is $4.1493 and diesel $6.1949 (AAA 29 OCT); gold ~$4,031; debt $40.582T (27 OCT).

ITEM 1: Hormuz — UKMTO Reports Vessel Afire North of Khasab; IRGC Says Three Tankers Hit Mines on the “Unauthorized” Southern Route; IRGC Claims Capture of US MQM-170 Drone

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

UKMTO said the master of a vessel reported seeing another vessel on fire about 9 NM north of Khasab, Oman, in the Strait of Hormuz at about 0300 GMT on 29 OCT; crew status was unknown, there was no damage or environmental assessment, authorities were investigating, and ships were told to transit with caution (CBS/AFP; Xinhua; Anadolu; Arab News). The UKMTO warning number was not found. On 29 OCT the IRGC Navy said three oil tankers “exploded and caught fire” after striking naval mines over the past 24 hours while trying to exit through “the unauthorized southern route,” that they had switched off radar and navigation systems, ignored IRGC warnings, and were stranded along the southern shore; it held owners and crews responsible (CBS; AP headline; Al Jazeera). The US has urged shippers to use the southern lane, which Trump declared mine-free at the end of August (CBS). The tankers were not named, and only one burning vessel has been reported by UKMTO. Separately, the IRGC Navy said its electronic warfare unit took control of and “safely

	landed" a US MQM-170 reconnaissance drone west of the strait, claiming it had launched from a southern Gulf state (CBS). No US response to either claim was found. This follows Iran's threat of "legal action" against Sinokor vessels starting 01 NOV.
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	If confirmed, mine strikes on the US-endorsed southern lane would undercut the CENTCOM mine-clearance claim and raise insurance and freight costs on the crude still moving through Hormuz. It also hands Washington a possible trigger for action days before the post-midterm window. Watch for a US Navy statement, vessel identities, and new UKMTO or JMIC advisories.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	CBS News live updates (29 OCT, read directly; carrying AFP and IRGC statements); Xinhua, Anadolu, Arab News, DW (UKMTO incident; search summaries); AP (headline only, body did not load); Al Jazeera live page (29 OCT, headline and bullets).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	No right-leaning coverage of the tanker or drone claims was found in the monitored feeds.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	CBS and Al Jazeera led with the IRGC's mine claim and its warning about the southern route; CBS noted Trump had declared that lane mine-free.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH that UKMTO reported one vessel on fire north of Khasab. LOW-MODERATE on three mine-struck tankers (IRGC claim only). LOW on the drone capture (IRGC claim only).

ITEM 2: Iran Track — Vance Letter to Rezaei Proposes Early Talks; Trump Says It Is About Medical Supplies; AP and Axios: Allies Told to Prepare for Post-Midterm Strikes, Possible Seven-Day Operation

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	The WSJ first reported, citing US officials, that Vance is engaging directly with Rezaei, the SNSC secretary and longtime former IRGC commander, at Trump's direction. Per the NYT, the letter went via Qatari mediators last week, reached Rezaei on Sunday (25 OCT), proposed an early meeting with Vance leading the US team, and named no date or venue; officials told the Times talks could begin as soon as next week in Qatar or Turkey and that Rezaei was expected to respond by Thursday (29 OCT). Axios reports the letter says any talks to prevent new strikes must cover Iran's nuclear program. Asked on 28 OCT, Trump said he had not sought to renew peace talks: "they need help with medical supplies and various things. He asked me what I thought and I said, 'If you want to do that that's okay'" (CBS). An official told CBS that Iran's response to Qatar's draft deal is expected by the end of the week, "most likely Saturday." Foreign Minister Araghchi said on X that Iran "continues to give diplomacy a chance" and is working with mediators on ideas to implement its "7-Day Plan," which Trump rejected in September. Two diplomats told AP that US officials have told Middle Eastern allies to prepare for possible renewed military action after the 03 NOV election and for Iranian retaliation against energy facilities and other infrastructure, and that a new round could last several days; Trump has not decided. Axios reports US and Israeli officials are preparing for a possible seven-day operation and that IDF chief Zamir spoke with CENTCOM's Adm. Cooper on 26 OCT to coordinate; it also reports Saudi Arabia urged the White House to give talks more time (via Gulf News). AP says the USS Theodore Roosevelt and amphibious ships carrying Marines, roughly 9,000 personnel, are heading to the region (via Gulf News); CBS says a third carrier and thousands of troops are en route.
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	Washington is running pressure and diplomacy at once: a direct vice-presidential channel to a hardline Iranian security chief while allies are told to brace for a short campaign. Iran's replies to Vance and to Qatar, both due by this weekend, are the last indicators before the election and the strike window.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	CBS News live updates (29 OCT, read directly; summarizing WSJ, NYT, Axios, AP); Gulf News (29 OCT, summarizing Axios and AP; search summary); Geo/Reuters (Qatar draft).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	TheBlaze and Fox News carried Vance's campaign rally remarks in Kinston, NC, but no right-leaning commentary on the Rezaei letter was found. Fox News highlighted Obama mocking Hegseth at an Atlanta rally.

MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	CBS framed the letter as an attempt to “restart peace negotiations” that Trump downplayed. Gulf News framed it as mounting pressure on Iran, with Gulf states pushing to avert a new war.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH that a Vance letter was sent (WSJ, NYT, Axios). MODERATE on its contents and timeline (anonymous officials). HIGH on Trump’s on-camera remarks. MODERATE-HIGH on the ally warnings (AP and WSJ, anonymous). MODERATE on the seven-day plan (Axios, anonymous).

ITEM 3: Pentagon — Hegseth Fires Joint Staff J5 Lt. Gen. Brett Sylvia Over Alleged Leaks on Iran and Ukraine

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	Defense Secretary Hegseth fired Army Lt. Gen. Brett Sylvia, the Joint Staff’s director for strategy, plans and policy (J5), on 28 OCT. A Pentagon official told CBS that Sylvia was accused of leaking classified information about the Iran war and the Russia-Ukraine war to the press, failed three polygraph tests, and that the case was referred to DOJ; no replacement has been named (CBS/AP). The Atlantic reported the firing first. He is the second J5 removed under Hegseth, after Lt. Gen. Joseph McGee was forced to retire last October, and one of nearly two dozen senior officers removed during Hegseth’s tenure. The Joint Staff thanked Sylvia for 32 years of service. The Washington Post headlined that Hegseth’s team “forces out” Sylvia.
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	The J5 coordinates war plans between the Chairman and the President, so the post is vacant days before a possible Iran campaign. A leak referral to DOJ also signals a tighter information clampdown around the strike planning now being reported in the press.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	CBS/AP (29 OCT, read directly); AP, Washington Post, The Center Square (search summaries).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	No right-leaning coverage was found in the monitored feeds.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	AP and the Post framed it as the latest in a string of unexplained firings, coming “even as Trump considers new Iran strikes”; CBS quoted Sen. Mark Kelly calling Hegseth’s cuts a purge.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on the firing. MODERATE on the leak and polygraph allegations (single anonymous Pentagon official; Sylvia has not commented).

ITEM 4: Houthi–Saudi and Gulf — Another Missile at the Eastern Province; Houthis Hit Aden Airport; Kuwait Summons Iran’s Envoy

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	Coalition spokesman Turki al-Maliki said on 29 OCT that air defenses intercepted and destroyed a Houthi ballistic missile aimed at the Eastern Province; Civil Defense issued and then lifted alerts for the Eastern Province and Najran; no damage or casualties were reported (SPA; Anadolu; Dawn). On 28 OCT a Houthi missile fell inside the perimeter of Aden airport while a Saudi military aircraft was there, after the Houthis called for the airport to be evacuated; the plane was not hit (AFP via CBS). Yemen’s transport ministry called it the sixth Houthi attack on Aden airport. Houthi media said Saudi strikes on a market and petrol station in al-Jawf killed 14 (Almasirah via AFP; not independently confirmed). Kuwait summoned Iran’s ambassador on 28 OCT after Iran’s embassy denied that an Iranian citizen took part in a plot to assassinate Interior Minister Sheikh Fahad al-Yousef; a Kuwaiti court sentenced three men to death on 26 OCT (AFP via CBS). No Saudi confirmation of Ras Tanura damage and no new US embassy departure orders were found.
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	Houthi fire at Saudi oil country continues daily and, per AP, the US is warning allies that Iranian retaliation would target energy sites, so Gulf export risk stays elevated. Iran’s friction with Kuwait, which hosts US forces, adds to tension among US partners.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	Saudi Press Agency, Anadolu, Dawn (29 OCT; search summaries); CBS live updates carrying AFP (Aden, al-Jawf, Kuwait).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	No right-leaning coverage was found.

MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	AFP framed the Houthi campaign as a sustained escalation against Riyadh and its Yemeni allies.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on the Saudi-reported intercept. HIGH on the Aden airport strike (police source and Houthi claim). LOW on the al-Jawf toll (Houthi media only).

ITEM 5: US Economy / Markets — Fed Holds 10–2 With Two Hike Dissents; Warsh Cuts Policy Meetings From 2027; Stocks Up Again; Alphabet Falls, Microsoft Rises After Hours; Q3 GDP and PCE Due at 0730 CT

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	The FOMC held the federal funds target at 3.75%–4.00% on 28 OCT in a 10–2 vote; Governor Lisa Cook and Cleveland Fed President Beth Hammack dissented in favor of a quarter-point hike. The statement says “inflation remains elevated” and “the accumulation of more information” will guide policy (Federal Reserve). Warsh said Q3 growth “appears” to be running above 3%, the job market is “quite positive,” and inflation has run above target for close to six years. He announced that from 2027 one of eight FOMC meetings will be a strategy session with no rate vote or statement, rising to two in 2028 (Fed transcript; CNBC). CNBC called Cook’s dissent “a stunner”; she has not dissented since joining in 2022. The Bank of Canada raised its rate 25 basis points to 2.5% (Global Market Now, citing the BoC release). On 28 OCT the Dow rose 97.53 points (0.19%) to 52,475.10, the S&P 500 rose 0.28% to 7,743.98, and the Nasdaq rose 0.27% to 26,549.85, a third straight gain; Oracle jumped nearly 11% on a fiscal 2030 outlook of $225 billion (CNBC). After the close Alphabet fell more than 10% after missing estimates, with adjusted EPS of $2.67 vs $3.02 expected and negative free cash flow of $9.07 billion; Microsoft rose about 4% on adjusted EPS of $4.89, revenue up 19% to $92.28 billion, and Azure up 48% (Sharecast). Brent settled up $1.44 at $115.32 (Reuters via Global Market Now) and WTI near $102.78; the 10-year Treasury yield traded above 5.02% intraday (CNBC). Early 29 OCT Brent was around $114.10 and WTI above $101, easing on diplomatic reports (The National; FXStreet; search summaries). BEA releases the Q3 GDP advance estimate and September PCE at 0830 ET (0730 CT); consensus is 3.2% GDP and core PCE 0.3% m/m and 3.1% y/y, with the Cleveland Fed nowcast at 3.60% headline PCE y/y (SMC Terminal; Cleveland Fed). Amazon reports today. AAA national regular fell to $4.2258 from $4.2471; national diesel eased to $6.3347 from $6.3499 (AAA, 29 OCT).
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	Two hawkish dissents, including a rare one from a governor, show pressure to hike again in December if today’s PCE comes in hot. A 10-year yield above 5% keeps mortgage and business borrowing costs high. Alphabet’s cash-flow miss is the first crack in the AI trade that has carried stocks. Gas keeps easing in Minnesota and nationally, but oil near $115 limits further relief.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	Federal Reserve statement and Warsh press conference transcript (28 OCT); CNBC takeaways and markets live page (28 OCT); AP (search summary); Sharecast (earnings); Global Market Now (settlements, BoC); The National and FXStreet (29 OCT oil; search summaries); BEA release schedule (read directly); AAA (29 OCT).
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	Fox News framed the hold as coming “six days before the midterm elections, as inflation continues to weigh on the U.S. economy.” Fox also highlighted Obama blaming Trump’s handling of the economy and the Iran war for rising costs.
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	AP framed the Fed as holding “despite stubbornly high inflation,” with Warsh saying its policies are already working. CNBC focused on the meeting-schedule change and Cook’s dissent.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on the Fed decision, closes, and earnings. MODERATE on this morning’s oil levels (search summaries). GDP and PCE results come after this report.

ITEM 6: Russia–Ukraine — Oleshky Truce Holds 54 Hours, Aid Due 30 OCT; Russian Drone Hits Train at

Dnipro Station, At Least 13 Dead

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

Ukrainian ombudsman Lubinets said on 29 OCT that the Oleshky ceasefire has held for 54 hours with “no violations,” routes are being demined, and an aid shipment will be delivered on 30 OCT; he is coordinating with Russian counterpart Yana Lantratova with mediation by Melania Trump (Ukrainska Pravda; AP). A Ukrainian delegation led by Lubinets set out toward Oleshky on 29 OCT, per Arakhamia (Kyiv Post). AP puts the number trapped at about 2,000; Lubinets had earlier estimated more than 6,000 in the area. The truce runs to 2259 Kyiv time on 01 NOV. Fox News reports Melania Trump held talks involving Putin and Zelenskyy and that both countries authorized her as an “exclusive intermediary” (headline; not independently confirmed). On the morning of 29 OCT a Russian jet-powered drone hit a passenger train on the platform at Dnipro station as it prepared to leave for Zaporizhzhia, killing at least 13 and wounding at least 13; the Air Force said four jet drones attacked around 1100 local and three were downed. Russian Banderol cruise missiles struck central Chernihiv around noon, killing two 15-year-old girls and injuring at least 23, and a drone strike on an apartment building in Kremenchuk killed at least three and injured 15 (Kyiv Independent). Zelenskyy linked the attacks to the “lifting [of] sanctions on some Russian oligarchs and energy companies” (Kyiv Independent); the details of that sanctions relief were not checked for this report.

US IMPACT ASSESSMENT

The US-brokered local truce is holding and the first aid delivery on 30 OCT is the key test. The Dnipro, Chernihiv, and Kremenchuk strikes show Russia continuing heavy attacks outside Kherson, which complicates the US case for wider talks in November.

SOURCE SYNOPSIS

Ukrainska Pravda (29 OCT); AP, Ukrinform, Guardian (search summaries); Kyiv Post (29 OCT); Kyiv Independent (29 OCT, read directly); Fox News X post.

MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)

Fox News played up Melania Trump’s “much bigger role” as an intermediary. No other right-leaning coverage was found.

MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)

AP and the Guardian framed Oleshky as a fragile humanitarian truce; the Kyiv Independent centered the Dnipro attack and Zelenskyy’s criticism of sanctions relief.

CONFIDENCE

HIGH that the truce is holding (both ombudsmen). HIGH on the Dnipro, Chernihiv, and Kremenchuk strikes (Ukrainian officials; tolls may rise). LOW on the “exclusive intermediary” report (single outlet, not confirmed).

ITEM 7: Elections and Justice — Judge Carter Denies DOJ Bid to Segregate California Ballots; NYT Alaska “Second Dan Sullivan” Report; Comey Motion Still Pending

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN

On the evening of 28 OCT US District Judge David O. Carter denied DOJ’s application for a TRO to make California stop processing ballots of about 20,000 people DOJ calls likely noncitizens. In a 26-page order he wrote, “Never before in American history has the federal government, on the eve of an election, sought to coerce a state and local government to abandon their own Constitutional elections procedures,” and “Once a vote is segregated, lasting harm has occurred.” He said the relief would “wreak havoc” and pointed DOJ to prosecuting individual illegal voters (NPR; AP; order via California AG). AP says more than 3.7 million Californians have already voted. The final order did not appoint a special master. No DOJ appeal was found as of this report. In Alaska, the NYT reported on 28 OCT that operatives tied to Democrat Mary Peltola’s Senate campaign helped recruit a second candidate named Dan Sullivan to draw votes from Republican Sen. Dan S. Sullivan (NYT; CNBC). DOJ has already sued to block certification if Sullivan loses and the second Sullivan’s votes could have changed the ranked-choice result, and Alaska officials have asked the court to dismiss (NBC; Washington Post). Timcast News says federal prosecutors are reportedly investigating (not confirmed). In the Comey case, Judge McFadden unsealed the case on 26

	OCT and has not ruled on the motion to dismiss (court order; search summary). TheBlaze reports a federal judge sided with Democrats against taxpayer-funded Trump ads (headline only; not reviewed).
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	Carter's denial removes the chance of a federal order to set aside California ballots before Election Day unless DOJ wins a fast appeal. The Alaska report gives DOJ's certification suit a new factual hook and could put the Senate result in court.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	NPR (28 OCT); AP (search summary); Carter order PDF via oag.ca.gov; NYT and CNBC (Alaska; search summaries); NBC, Washington Post (Alaska suit); Courthouse News (Comey order); TheBlaze and Timcast News X posts.
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	Timcast News called the Alaska effort an "alleged Democratic scheme" and its panel said Democrats think "ANYTHING is justified to stop Republicans." TheBlaze clipped Trump saying "every single Democrat voted against voter ID."
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	NPR and AP led with Carter's warning that the request would disenfranchise eligible voters and "wreak havoc." CNBC framed the Alaska story around Peltola campaign aides.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on the Carter ruling (order read in summary, multiple outlets). MODERATE-HIGH on the NYT Alaska report (single outlet, detailed). LOW on a federal criminal probe in Alaska (not confirmed). HIGH that no Comey ruling was found.

ITEM 8: Minnesota — Hennepin County Charges James O'Keefe and Cam Higby With Felony Unlawful Voting and Identity Theft; Omar Warrant Stays Sealed Pending Boasberg

WHAT / WHERE / WHEN	On 28 OCT Hennepin County Attorney Mary Moriarty charged conservative activist James O'Keefe and Cameron Higby with felony unlawful voting and identity theft over videos filmed during the 11 AUG Minnesota primary, in which they allegedly gave registered voters' names, including some dead residents and at least one who voted, while testing the state's vouching system. Moriarty said, "I think it's pretty clear they did not intend to vote," but "you cannot give somebody else's name and misrepresent yourself." Neither signed the vouching oath. Each faces up to five years and/or a $10,000 fine; first appearance is 16 NOV. Secretary of State Steve Simon said poll workers did exactly what they should and that attempts to deceive election workers "will not be tolerated." Higby denied breaking any law and is fundraising; O'Keefe did not respond to MPR (MPR; AP; Hennepin County Attorney). On Omar, DOJ opposes unsealing the search warrant and Judge Boasberg has not ruled; the Star Tribune, The Hill, and the Washington Post confirm the filing reported yesterday. Fox News reported Omar's first public appearance since the search, at a Minneapolis Somali mall with security. No charges against Omar and no ruling in the Good/Pretti evidence suit were found.
US IMPACT ASSESSMENT	The O'Keefe charges put Minnesota's vouching law, which allows a registered voter to vouch for up to eight people, at the center of national election-integrity arguments five days before the vote. Expect the case to be cast as political prosecution on the right and as protection of poll workers by state officials.
SOURCE SYNOPSIS	MPR News (28 OCT, read directly); AP, NBC, Hennepin County Attorney release, charging document via Courthouse News (search summaries); Star Tribune, The Hill, Washington Post (Omar; search summaries); Fox News X post.
MEDIA FRAMING (RIGHT)	Timcast News called the charges "political lawfare," and Tim Pool called O'Keefe "the greatest journalist of this generation." Tim Pool said Omar is "heading rapidly towards denaturalization," citing Glenn Beck's HSI memo claim (see quarantine).
MEDIA FRAMING (LEFT/MAINSTREAM)	MPR framed it as influencers charged with voter fraud for YouTube videos and noted O'Keefe's past legal trouble and the 2017 Washington Post sting.
CONFIDENCE	HIGH on the charges (prosecutor's announcement, multiple outlets). HIGH that the Omar warrant remains sealed with no ruling.

MN / US COST SNAPSHOT

RESIDENTIAL ELECTRICITY (MN)	17.20¢/kWh for August 2026 vs a US average of 18.16¢/kWh (EIA Electric Power Monthly Table 5.6.A, checked 29 OCT 26; no new month).
REGULAR GASOLINE (MN)	$4.1493/gal (AAA Minnesota, 29 OCT 26); yesterday $4.1704; week ago $4.2140; month ago $4.3119; year ago $2.8898. National AAA regular $4.2258, down from $4.2471 (AAA, 29 OCT 26).
DIESEL (MN)	$6.1949/gal (AAA Minnesota, 29 OCT 26); yesterday $6.2129; week ago $6.2208; month ago $6.2600; year ago $3.6339. National AAA diesel $6.3347, down from $6.3499 (AAA, 29 OCT 26).
GROUND BEEF (MN PROXY)	$7.253/lb for September 2026, all uncooked ground beef, Midwest Census Region urban (BLS via FRED APU0200FC1101; checked 29 OCT 26; no new month); August $7.317. Not Minnesota-specific.
GOLD SPOT	$4,030.50/troy oz (gold-api.com XAU/USD, 29 OCT 26 ~0720 CDT / 1220 UTC), down from $4,057.80 on 28 OCT. This is a proxy feed, not Kitco/LBMA.
US NATIONAL DEBT	$40,582,274,254,843.57 total public debt outstanding (Treasury Debt to the Penny, record date 27 OCT 26), up about $53.9 billion from $40,528,358,939,415.85 on 26 OCT.

OPEN THREADS CARRIED FORWARD

Iran	Rezaei's reply to the Vance letter (expected 29 OCT per NYT); Iran's reply to Qatar's draft (likely Saturday 31 OCT); Trump's post-midterm decision and the reported seven-day operation; Theodore Roosevelt group and Marine arrival; Pickaxe Mountain (no new reporting); China's envoys; IRGC undersea cable threat.
Gulf shipping	identity of the burning vessel off Khasab and the three tankers Iran says hit mines; any US Navy confirmation; the MQM-170 drone claim; Sinokor "legal action" from 01 NOV; 183-26 vessel off Al-Faw; next JMIC update.
Pentagon	J5 replacement for Sylvia; DOJ leak referral.
Israel	final count (Netanyahu bloc 53, Eisenkot bloc 48, Arab parties 19 at 96.1% counted per israelielections.com; double envelopes pending); Netanyahu's fraud allegation against Arab parties; coalition talks.
Force protection	further embassy departure orders (none new found); US casualty count (21 per the Pentagon via Al Jazeera, carried).
Saudi/Yemen	Ras Tanura damage (still unconfirmed); Aden airport attacks; Egypt deployment, if requested.
Economy	Q3 GDP and September PCE (0730 CT today); Amazon earnings today; Cook and Hammack dissent statements; December FOMC; Canada tariff changes 30 OCT (not rechecked); DOE SPR exchange award (still not found).
Russia/Ukraine	Oleshky aid delivery 30 OCT and evacuations; truce end 2259 Kyiv time 01 NOV; Dnipro toll; the sanctions relief Zelenskyy cited; Abu Dhabi talks in November; Ukraine's refinery-strike pause.
DOJ and elections	any DOJ appeal of Carter's denial; the Alaska certification suit and any criminal probe; Comey's motion to dismiss; the Swalwell/Cloobeck investigation; the $1 million reward.
Minnesota	O'Keefe/Higby first appearance 16 NOV; Boasberg's Omar sealing decision; any Omar charges (none found); ruling on the Good/Pretti evidence suit (none found); early voting.

UNCONFIRMED / QUARANTINED

- IRGC claims that three tankers hit mines on the southern route and that it captured a US MQM-170 drone: only one burning vessel is confirmed by UKMTO, and no US statement was found.

- A Trump supporter stabbed outside a Trump rally in Chillicothe, Ohio (Eric Daugherty post reposted by Tim Pool): not confirmed by police or a news outlet in this review.
- Fox News report that Russia and Ukraine named Melania Trump their “exclusive intermediary”: single outlet, not confirmed.
- Timcast News claim that federal prosecutors are investigating the Alaska “second Dan Sullivan” effort: not confirmed.
- Timcast News “left-wing playbook” to shut down commerce in an election crisis: source document not reviewed.

Houthi claim of 14 dead in Saudi strikes in al-Jawf — Houthi media only.

Carry-forward — Glenn Beck’s leaked HSI Omar memo (not published or confirmed by DHS or DOJ); Bessent’s reported $1 billion in Iran-linked crypto; Timcast’s Microsoft buyout and 90-day base-independence claims; Houthi claim of a Ras Tanura refinery hit; the $1 billion Saudi offer to the Houthis via Iran; the Sirik launcher strike report; IRGC two-supertanker and seven-ship claims; Trump’s 301% Iran inflation figure.

GAPS AND NOTES

UKMTO — the warning number for the Khasab fire was not found; the warnings index loads by script and could not be read. The vessel’s name and flag are unknown.

- The WSJ, NYT, and Axios reports on the Vance letter and the seven-day plan are paywalled or were read through CBS’s and Gulf News’s summaries. AP’s tanker and O’Keefe stories did not load in full.
- Q3 GDP and September PCE release at 0730 CT, at this report’s cutoff; results are not included. This morning’s oil levels come from search summaries.
- Israel’s count is 96.1% (israelielections.com search summary); the final count was expected 29 OCT.

Closed from yesterday — Judge Carter ruled (denied the TRO, no special master appointed); the FOMC decision; Microsoft and Alphabet earnings.

- EIA electricity (August 2026) and BLS beef (September 2026) have no new month. Gold is a proxy feed. Treasury’s latest debt record is 27 OCT.

Right-leaning coverage — X feeds of TheBlaze, Glenn Beck, Daily Wire, Ben Shapiro, Tim Pool/Timcast, Timcast News, Steven Crowder, S2 Underground, and Fox News were searched from 1200 UTC on 28 OCT. Found: TheBlaze clips of Obama’s Atlanta rally, Trump on voter ID, Vance’s Kinston rally, Omar segments, and a judge ruling on Trump ads; Fox News on the Fed, Omar’s mall appearance, Obama on Hegseth, and Melania Trump; Timcast on O’Keefe, Alaska, Omar, and the EAS test; Ben Shapiro on Utah’s charges against Kalshi co-founder Tarek Mansour. No posts from S2 Underground or Crowder were found, and no right-leaning coverage of Hormuz, the Vance letter, Sylvia, or Saudi Arabia was found in these feeds.

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